

Shashi Shekhar

Credit Risk Strategy

s.shashi24@outlook.com | linkedin.com/in/shashi--shekhar | Bengaluru, India | Open to relocation

PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Credit risk strategist with 5+ years in lending analytics, currently in Global Credit Risk at PayPal on a \$2B+ business lending book. I design credit policy, default definitions and loan-level profitability models, and take them from analysis to the production rule engine. I report early-delinquency and guardrail metrics to the credit risk committee.

SKILLS

Credit strategy: Credit policy and decision-engine design, buy-box design, swap-set analysis, risk grading, PD calibration, champion-challenger testing, vintage loss (VLR) and gross credit loss (GCL) analysis, multi-horizon default definition, pricing and line assignment, loan-level P&L (CLTV), Open Banking underwriting, IFRS 9 PD/EAD/LGD, collections early warning

Modelling: Gradient boosting (XGBoost, LightGBM), scorecards, CART, survival analysis (Cox PH), SHAP

Data and tools: Python, SQL, R, PySpark, AWS, Snowflake, Tableau, Power BI

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Data Scientist, Global Credit Risk

PayPal, Bengaluru | Nov 2024 – Present

- Redesigned US credit policy using commercial bureau data and PD calibration, and built the models behind it: defined the buy box, ran swap-set analysis against the previous rule strategy, determined gross credit loss (GCL) under balance control and assigned risk grades by t-statistics. **3% uplift in post-bureau eligibility** and **\$150MM more in booked loans** at a **2% lower vintage loss rate**.
- Designed a **multi-horizon default definition** after showing that a single early delinquency indicator was statistically insufficient; validated by champion-challenger with population stability monitoring; adopted as the production rule layer, cutting vintage loss rate by **2.5%** with a realised profit uplift.
- Built a multi-year **lifetime-value (CLTV) model** by score band and customer type, showing which segments **earn back their acquisition cost**; sets the score-band cut-off strategy and guides pricing and acquisition decisions.
- Designed the approve/decline underwriting rules for a **UK Open Banking business-loan launch**; the production rule engine adopted them unchanged.
- Designed a bank-based underwriting decision engine: consolidated redundant legacy rules and combined internal PD models with external bureau scores across bureau, Open Banking and no-document paths, all resolving to pricing and line assignment.
- Launched Open Banking underwriting for US business loans and eliminated data-extraction failures within weeks of launch.
- Direct 2 external consultant data scientists.

Senior Manager, Analytics – Risk & Data Science

Liquiloans, Mumbai | Feb 2024 – Oct 2024

- Led a **team of 5** (3 full-time, 2 interns) across scorecards, collections and credit strategy.
- Built application, behaviour and propensity scorecards (gradient boosting, SHAP): **10% uplift in approval rate** and **0.5% reduction in NPA**.
- Built the early-warning system used by collections and credit teams, raising **collection efficiency 30%**; developed cross-sell and partnership credit strategies from loss forecasting (IFRS 9 PD/EAD/LGD).

Business Analyst – Strategy, Growth & Risk

Jodo, Bengaluru | Oct 2022 – Dec 2023

- Built the company's first in-house credit risk model, from zero: 40% faster underwriting turnaround and a newly identified customer segment. Managed 2 interns.
- Built the AWS data warehouse pipeline (Glue, PySpark), cutting data turnaround 40× and automating 80% of ad-hoc reporting.

Data Analyst – Data Science Consulting

Accelera Eloquent, New Delhi | Jan 2021 – Oct 2022

- Built segmentation and NLP models for retail and eCommerce clients (footfall +30%); a Bayesian A/B testing framework lifted new-product sales 10%.

EDUCATION

B.Tech, Electronics & Communication Engineering

IIIT Guwahati, India | 2019